

also packs some impressive features into the C350E. The small screen aside, coloured buttons, white backlight and the matching body, give this cell phone an overall great look.

Coming to ergonomics and usability, the Koreans have tasted success by emulating Finnish phone makers Nokia. In the range of flip phones, LG's G7030 is easily the model with the perfect layout of buttons, a great tactile feel and a splendid menu interface that is simple to navigate. Closely following this model are both the phones from Samsung. They have an equally good menu interface—totally different from the LG set, but still simple to operate. The grouping of menus is simply immaculate. Nokia switchers will find it easy to relate to them.

On the other hand, Pantech dons a more colourful and lively menu that is very appealing. However, using this model over a sustained period of time might make you feel that the colourful animation is overdone. The Philips 630 has a simple and straight forward approach to menu interface and button layout. The simplicity of the interface makes up for the lack of

a flashy look.

Despite the odd shape and layout of the keypad, Nokia's 2300 works without any hiccups. The BenQ M555C boasts of a great five-way rocker key and an easy-to-use menu interface. Sagem phones use the same approach that Nokia uses—a combination of a four-way rocker key with two soft keys. Sony-Ericsson's T230, Motorola's C350E, Siemens' A60 and Philips' 9@9++, all work on the same approach of four-way rocker and two soft buttons for browsing the menu. In fact, Bird's S288 is the only phone that uses a two-way rocker for menu browsing, which is really cumbersome.

Those on the lookout for feather-light handsets should know that the S288 from Bird is the lightest and slimmest phone available today—it weighs just 65 grams. The sleek Samsung SGH-X430 follows closely with 73 grams. The additional weight is solely due to the flip form factor, which makes the set bulkier. EB-G51, the light Panasonic model, is the ideal for people who are choosy about phones that are light and fit perfectly in the smallest of places. Even



Bird S288
Rating: **B+**
Price: Rs 5,499

SCORE BOARD

CATEGORY

CELL PHONE MID-RANGE

Brand	Alcatel	Benq	Bird	Bird	LG	LG	Motorola	Nokia
Model	Onetouch 535	M555C	S1190	S288	G3100	G7030	C350E	2300
Basic features								
Antenna	Internal	Internal	External	Internal	Internal	External	Internal	Internal
Weight (gm)	88	80	78	65	85	88	85	92
Dimensions (mm)	106 x 47 x 20	99 x 42 x 18	85.3 x 44.2 x 20.8	103 x 44 x 12	84x44x20.5	85 x 45 x 23	NA	107 x 46 x 21
Network band support	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band	Dual Band
Rated standby time (hours)	260	210	150	220	200	200	215	400
Rated talk time (hours)	6	4	5	2.5	2	2.5	4.5	4.5
Display screen								
Number of colours	4096	4096	4096	Mono	4096	65,000	4096	Mono
Resolution	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128	128 x 128
No of lines of text	4	4	4	4	4	5	4	4
In-built ringtones type	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic	Polyphonic
No of contacts in Phone / Fields	800 / 10	NA	200	300	150	255 / 3	100	50
Call records (received / dialled / missed)	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10	10 / 10 / 10
Calendar								
Type of view	Monthly, Weekly	Monthly, Weekly	None	None	Monthly, Weekly	Monthly, Weekly	Monthly, Weekly	None
Scheduler	✓	✓	None	None	✓	✓	✓	None
Send note	✓	✓	None	None	✓	✓	✓	✓
Miscellaneous features								
Alarm / World clock	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗
Calculator / Converter	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗
Handsfree / Voice recorder	✓/✓	✗/✗	✗/✗	✓/✗	✗/✗	✓/✓	✗/✗	✓/✗
FM Radio	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
WAP / GPRS	✓/✓	✓/✓	✗/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✓	✗/✗
Number of games	✓/2	✓/2	✓/3	✓/3	✓/1	✓/1	✓/2	✓/2
USABILITY								
Pocketability	3.25	4	3.5	4.5	3.25	3.25	3.5	3.5
Ergonomics	4	3.75	3	3.5	3.5	4	3.25	3.75
Typing speed and ease of use	2.5	3	2	2	3.75	4	2.5	4.5
Signal reception	3.5	3.5	3	2	3	3.5	3.5	4
Voice clarity	3.5	3.5	3	2	3	3.5	3.5	4
FINAL SCORE								
Grand Total	71.26	68.52	48.95	54.97	63.85	72.45	67.06	72.77
Price	6450	5990	5999	5499	6900	13000	5545	6919
VFM	1.10	1.14	0.82	1.00	0.93	0.56	1.21	1.05
Grade	A-	A-	B-	B+	B	C-	A	B+